

John William Alexander Miller

The Miller family history begins with John Wm A. the son of Abraham Miller. John was born about 1828 in Washington D.C. Near 1849-50 he married Anna Elizabeth Blackstone, who was born in Devonshire England. She had lived in a place of the same name as that of her father. Of true such a circumstance would ordinarily indicate she came of a more or less landed gentry.

So far the family story poses a mystery unsolvable. As searching has been done in all areas without success.

How or where did John meet a lady of her class and who was disowned for marrying him. It is interesting to speculate on the circumstances of the match. But to find the facts requires a great deal more research.

To John and Anna Elizabeth was born a son named —
John Thomas Miller

Note

Since the above was written I have learned John W. A. Miller was born in Germany. Which clears up the problem of his marriage to Anna Elizabeth Blackstone. We can assume they were married in England. And now the search goes to there.

Son George also stated John went to Baltimore and worked as an apprentice under John Wm. Bruce. Which would indicate some friendly connection between the Miller and Bruce families:

John Wm. Bruce worked for the Baltimore and Ohio railroad in their shops, as did as many as four or five of his sons through the years. While John Thomas was learning blacksmithing he lived with the Bruces. But apparently he did not follow the Bruces to Piedmont W. Va. when John Bruce was transferred to superintend the big Baltimore and Ohio shop there. No one of the Bruce family ever mentioned John Miller.

But in 1872 he went to Westport, just across the river from Piedmont W. Va., to marry Anna Bruce. The marriage license dated 13 of September ¹⁸⁷² shows John's age as twenty and his residence as Baltimore Md. and painter as his occupation.

Anna is noted as W. Anna Bruce age seventeen. She never used her name Williamannah. Who could blame her? What a terrible name to give a little girl. I think just because she was the seventh daughter and daddy thought he would never have another son he could name William. Then he did have one right after Anna. He should have been more patient.

But back to John T. We wonder if he did learn to be a blacksmith. For painter fits better with the story of his being a carriage painter. And that he also made calling cards. And we know ~~we~~ how they were so beautifully ~~they were~~ done by hand, and would be of the same fine painstaking form of art.

Johns and Annas family soon began to arrive, and grow.

Funeral To Be Held Wednesday For J. T. Miller

Funeral services will be held this afternoon at 2:30 from the chapel of the Baldwin Park Funeral Home for John Thomas Miller, 87, of 1425 E. Valley boulevard, El Monte, who passed away November 20.

Mr. Miller, who was born April 17, 1851, at Washington D. C., had been a resident of El Monte three years and of the state 12 years.

The deceased a widower, is survived by three sons, Asa Miller, 217 Bogart street; John R. Miller, 134 N. Center street, Baldwin Park; and George Miller of St. Louis; and two daughters, Mrs. Emma Prosser and Mrs. Lulu Lutten, both of 1425 E. Valley, El Monte.

Burial will be in the Rose Hills cemetery.

you can follow that growth on the family record sheet. She was such a little thing to have so many children. We know he was a small and attractive young girl.

The family started out with Charles Asa, as you can see, who was born in Westernport Md. Also the sister who followed him. The next little girl ^{born} ~~and~~ in Piedmont W. Va. and both died in their infancy.

What a terrible blow to the young parents. Erma and Oliver were also born in W. Va. William in Minnesota, John in Joliet Ill. also George and Lula in E. St. Louis Ill.

Life was not easy ^{for} little mother Annah. For John was a rover from his early years. The first long trip was made to Cedar Rapids Iowa when ^{Oliver} was only seven months old because he had a job there. They were a much traveled family before they finally landed in E. St. Louis. John's itchy feet had kept them moving ever farther west. No wonder Charles Asa said the main thing he remembered was "moving".

The family's life seemed settled down in St. Louis. And the family grew up and some were married and had children. Son Oliver's daughter told me the only thing she remembers about the family in St. Louis was that her grandparents lived on a farm.

That was just surprising! Nomads don't farm, they just move on to greener pastures. They really needed time to rest, I guess. But farm they did, or at least lived on one. For the grand daughter recalls all of the apples she ate there. And they must have raised a lot of carrots for I recall dad Asa saying he never wanted to eat another carrot, he got sick of them.

While the Millers lived in St. Louis many members of Annah's

Bruce family came to visit them, as many of them had passes for railroad travel and others were financially able to afford it many made trips out to see them. This of course would have made Annah very happy. For she was so isolated from all of her father's family.

It is not possible to say how long the family lived in St. Louis. But several of the family were married there and had their children born there. Son George was the only one of the family who never came west. He said the Bruces were still visiting in St. Louis as late as 1905 as there were out to see the World's Fair there.

Some time along the way the family visited in Clifton, and there is no record of when they came to Calif. to live. Where six of them later died, correction, seven of the family died in California.

Not enough is known of John and Annah's family to give more than a few biographical notes.

Charles Asa was a plumbing and heating contractor. Oliver's daughter said her father was a coal and ice dealer. He had the largest family, eight children. Asa had eight, but raised 5. George had three, he was a city man, urbane, pleasant and self-assured. John was an inventor, a builder and full of ideas. He invented the home water heater. He served in World War I and fought in France. He and wife May had no children, neither did Erma, nor Wallace who married late and died very soon after. Lula had two children.

John and Annah did well ^{as} the progenitors and founders of the Miller clan and a family to be proud ^{and} of who in turn have followed in their footsteps.

Note - John T. Miller came to Cal. in 1938